

Work-Based Learning Improves Student Outcomes: Replicate Our Methodology

Work-Based Learning Reporting Infrastructure at the San Diego Community College District

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Community College District

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College of Continuing Education

Plan & Intention

Our Plan

- Overview of WBL
- How we got where we are now
- Districtwide Dashboard
- Data Engagement
- ChatGPT
- Key Consideration

Our Intention

- Increase awareness of the importance of WBL for student success
- Provide insights into a regional and districtwide reporting model
- Share Lessons Learned
- Provide tools for replication

Work-Based Learning *Districtwide Student Success Initiative*

Our Why



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Student Success = Career Success
Career Services is a Basic Need

WBL is the Backbone of Career Services



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Our Why



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Student Success = Career Success

Students are looking for improved work outcomes & communities
improved work outcomes

Students say.... Work outcomes are the primary motivation for choosing higher education, more than double the percentage representing the next most prevalent motivation.

Source: Strada Center for Education Consumer Insights report "Why higher ed?"

Our Why



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Career Services as a Basic Need

Student career success requires career services

Support for career exploration, career goal setting,
and practical hands-on, career connected
experiences are needed for career success

When we talk about strengthening student success, we have to
talk about strengthening career services and WBL opportunities

Our Why

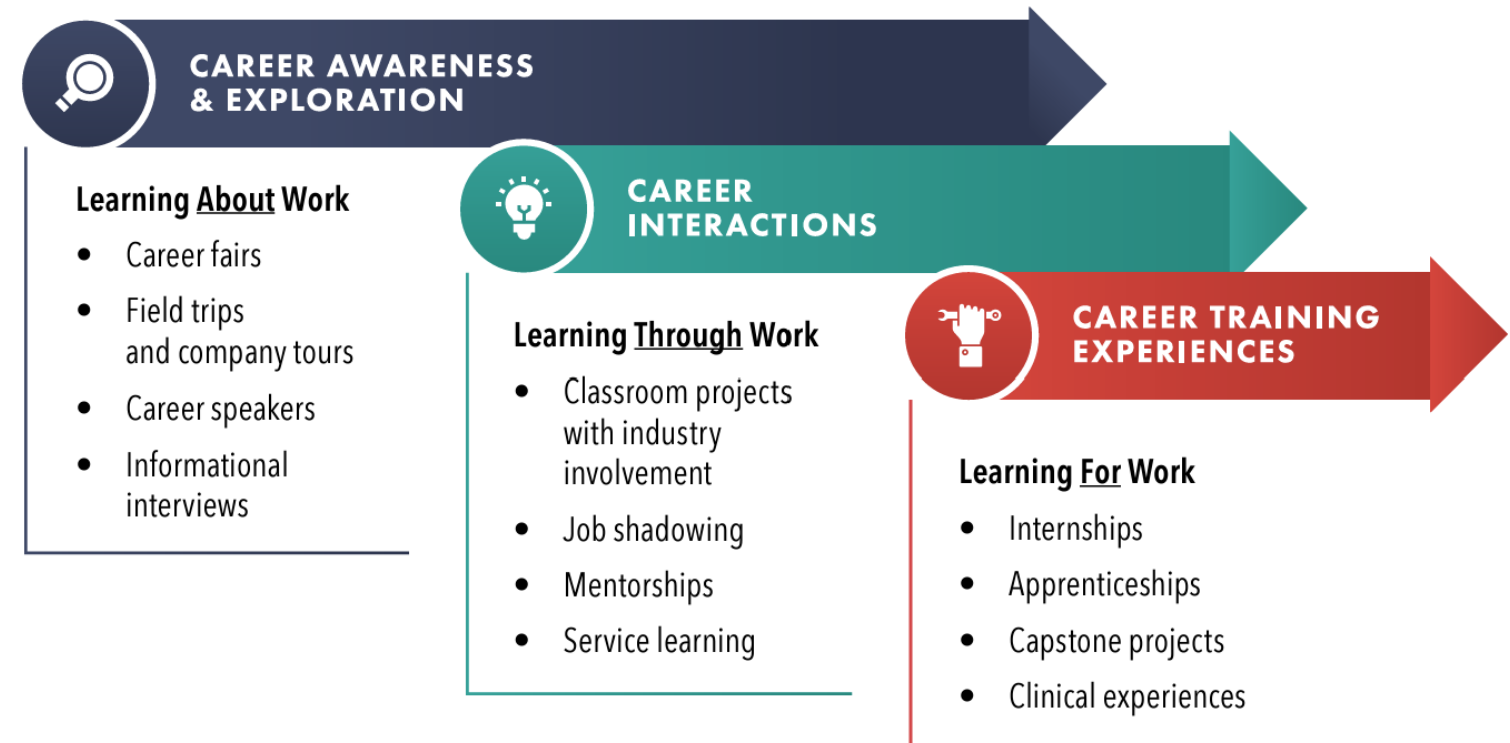


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Work-Based Learning as the backbone of Career Services

WBL as a recruitment, retention, and success strategy

Career Everywhere



What is Work-Based Learning?

Regional Definition:

The term “work-based learning” means sustained interactions with industry or community professionals in real workplace settings, to the extent practicable, or simulated environments at an educational institution that foster in-depth, firsthand engagement with the tasks required in a given career field, that are aligned to curriculum and instruction. Perkins V Sec. 3. [20 U.S.C. 2302] (55)

Why is Work-Based Learning important?

- Infusing industry into the classroom
- Helping students meet their goals
- Engaging employers into our programs and on our campuses

WBL is also an MIS reporting requirement –

SG21

MIS SG21 - WBL

Find out
where each
college
stands!



Special Population Data Elements

DED#	DATA ELEMENT NAME	FORMAT
SG21	STUDENT-WORK-BASED-LEARNING-STATUS	X

This element indicates whether the student participated in specific types of work-based learning during the reporting term.

Note: If the student is identified as participating in more than one type of work-based learning during the reporting term, report the first applicable code (A through C).

Coding	Meaning
A	Student participated in work-based learning preparing the student for employment in a specific range of occupations, such as internships, work experience, and capstone projects.
B	Student participated in work-based learning allowing the student to apply learning through practical experience and interaction with professionals from industry and the community outside of school, such as job shadows, service learning, class projects or challenges, and mentorships.
C	Student participated in work-based learning allowing the student to build awareness of the variety of careers available, begin identifying areas of interest, and explore career options, such as guest speakers, company tours, field trips, career fairs, and mock interviews.
N	Student did not participate in work-based learning
X	Unknown/unreported

Goals



1. Increase WBL opportunities for all students
2. Support faculty for increased integration of WBL opportunities into the curriculum
3. Improve understanding of the student journey across/throughout the WBL continuum
4. Improve understanding of the impact WBL has on employment and completion

Assumptions



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- WBL is an integral component to preparing students for careers - WBL is needed for employment
- The more WBL opportunities, the better - WBL increases the likelihood of enrollment (recruitment), retention, and completion
- All career education programs should include WBL opportunities
- Students engage in various WBL activities; it is not necessarily a linear progression
- WBL integrated into the curriculum has a more significant impact on student success than WBL solely provided outside of a course and program activities
- WBL provided solely outside of the curriculum present challenges for students

Outcomes



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Sunny – are these bullets true? Make any updates you want

What we are seeing so far...

- Doubled the number of WBL opportunities
- Higher retention, success, and completion for WBL students compared to non WBL students
- Positive representation/participation across race/ethnicity groups
- 25% of WBL students are first generation

We know it is working, but we still have a long ways to go...

How We Got Here

What we've done so far



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Leveraged External Reporting Requirement

**Leveraged Regional Investment &
Coordination**

Focused on Practitioner Learning

**Built out a districtwide reporting
infrastructure**

- Tied to districtwide WBL goals
- Designed to test assumptions
- Integrated Coding into Local Systems
- Made it visible
- Made it usable

Where we are now: Focused on engagement

Where We Started



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Regional Engagement & Regional Investment

WBL & Job Placement Workgroup

Regional SWP Funding for WBL Coordinators

Regional WBL Glossary

Regional Reporting Framework

Coding Details



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Our Focus:

1. Make it meaningful to practitioners (design reporting/coding infrastructure with end user in mind)
2. Integrate coding into systems
3. Connect coding mechanisms to delivery
4. Make it visible to students and to practitioners
5. Support Faculty Leadership of WBL to embed and improve WBL

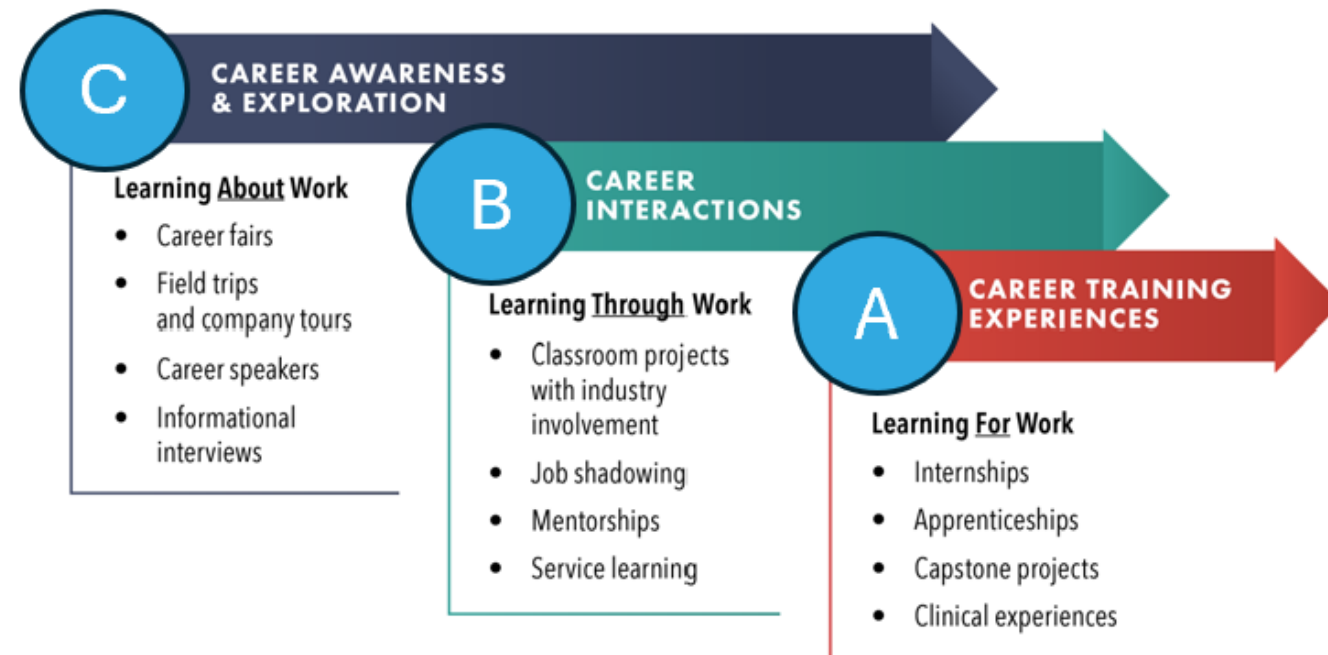
Coding Details

Make it meaningful



1. Building out a coding framework with the end goal in mind

- Mapping to MIS SG21 Data Element
- Leveraging regional WBL Glossary
- Creating subcategories



Coding Details

Make it meaningful



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Building a Subcategory reporting Framework

- Subcategories enable distinction within MIS A,B, C categories
- Better aligns with how WBL is delivered
- Provides baseline for future comparison

A1 – Paid Internship
A2 – Unpaid Internship
A3 - Work Experience
A4 - Capstone Project

Coding	Meaning
A	Student participated in work-based learning preparing the student for employment in a specific range of occupations, such as internships, work experience, and capstone projects.
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Coding Details

Systems Integration
& Consideration of
Delivery



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2. Integrate coding into systems

- Understanding MIS SG21 Data Element
 - *Term based; hierarchical; deduped*
- Understanding Local MIS SG21 Reporting Program
 - *Source files; roll-up*
- Understanding Campus Solutions and Where Codes Live
 - Course / section codes & student attributes table

3. Tie Reporting Mechanisms to WBL Delivery

- Consideration of where the WBL occurs
 - *Inside or Outside the classroom*
- Ties back to goals & assumptions

Challenges: Building the team; the MIS world; technology limitations;
new/more work on peoples' already full plates

Coding Details

Consideration of
Delivery / WBL
Delivery: Inside &
Outside the
Classroom



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Extra-Curricular Coding

- Outside of the classroom
- Career Center Focused
- Tied to student attributes page in campus solutions

Challenges: coding infrastructure made cumbersome due to technology limitations; capacity constraints

Coding Details

Consideration of
Delivery / WBL
Delivery: Inside &
Outside the Classroom



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Instructional Coding

- Inside the classroom
- Tied to section coding page within campus solution
- Course Level Coding - *WBL activities as a required, integrated course activity regardless of term, modality, or instructor*
- Section Level Coding - *WBL activities specific to instructor, term, or modality*
- WBL Icon – Online Schedule Visibility

Tips: Focus on the course level (COR) & code what you know

Challenges: General Buy-in, Aligned Curriculum, Timing, Rolled Schedule, and Faculty Awareness

Faculty Awareness

Supporting Faculty Leadership of WBL

WBL is instructional
(regardless of what MIS says)



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- **Engagement**
- **Training/Professional Development**
 - Regional Training
- **Promising Practices:**
 - Focusing WBL Coordinators on instructional engagement
 - Faculty Liaisons
 - Incentives
 - Make it visible

Challenges: Timing & Technology Constraints

Coding Details Make it Visible



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Making it Visible for Students

- WBL icon in online schedule
- Searchable



Making it Visible to Faculty

- COR
- Faculty Portal
- Data Engagement

Making it Visible to Practitioners

- Data Engagement

Importance of Teams



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Cross Functional Teams Needed

- Student Services & Instructional Services
- Senior Leadership – beyond CTE
- IT/MIS
- Research
- Curriculum Leadership (Instructional Coding leads)

Key Roles:

- WBL Coordinators
- Faculty Champions

Data Engagement



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Leveraging Data for...

- Phase 1:
 - Reporting Counts
 - Focused on infrastructure building
- Phase 2:
 - Developing a Dashboard
 - Connecting dots with student outcomes
- Phase 3: *(where we are now)*
 - Applying the data – data insights, facilitated reflection, goal setting for data informed interventions
 - Dashboard Enhancements

WBL Dashboard Impact:

Driving Student Success & Visibility

32,272

Students Participated

in Work-Based Learning

41%

Engaged in WBL

of all SDCCD students

69%

Students of Color

of all WBL students

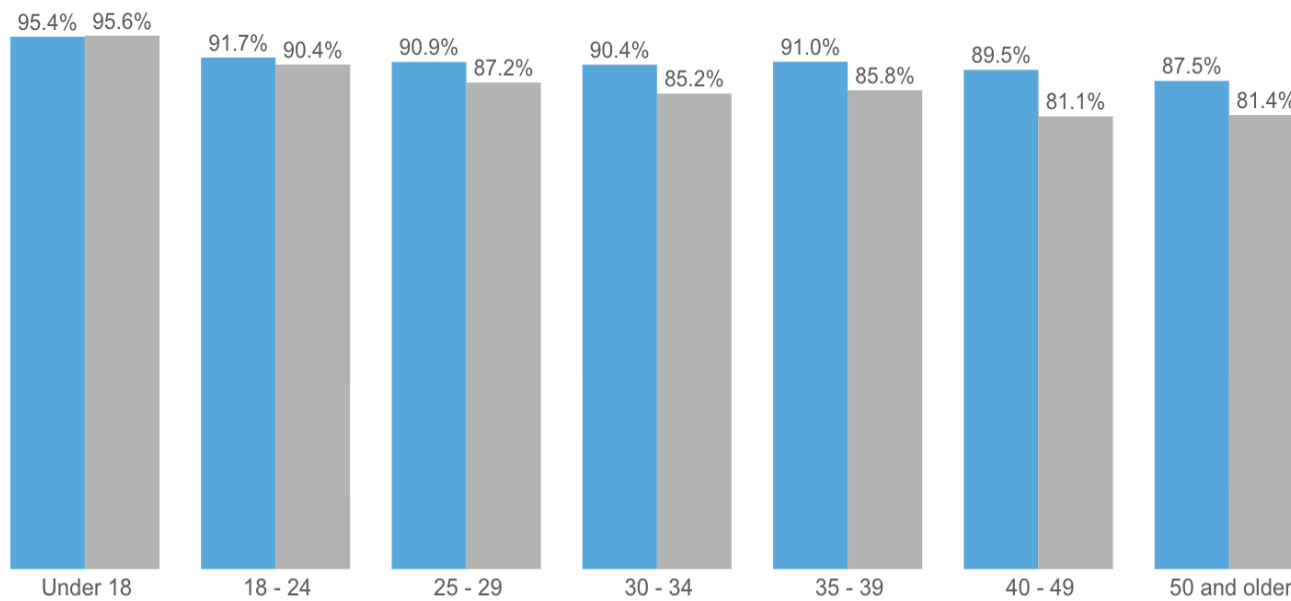
 **More Visibility:** WBL became visible across all colleges

Data-Driven Advocacy: Concrete data and talking points supported effective advocacy for WBL

WBL Students have Better Outcomes, Especially for Adult Learners

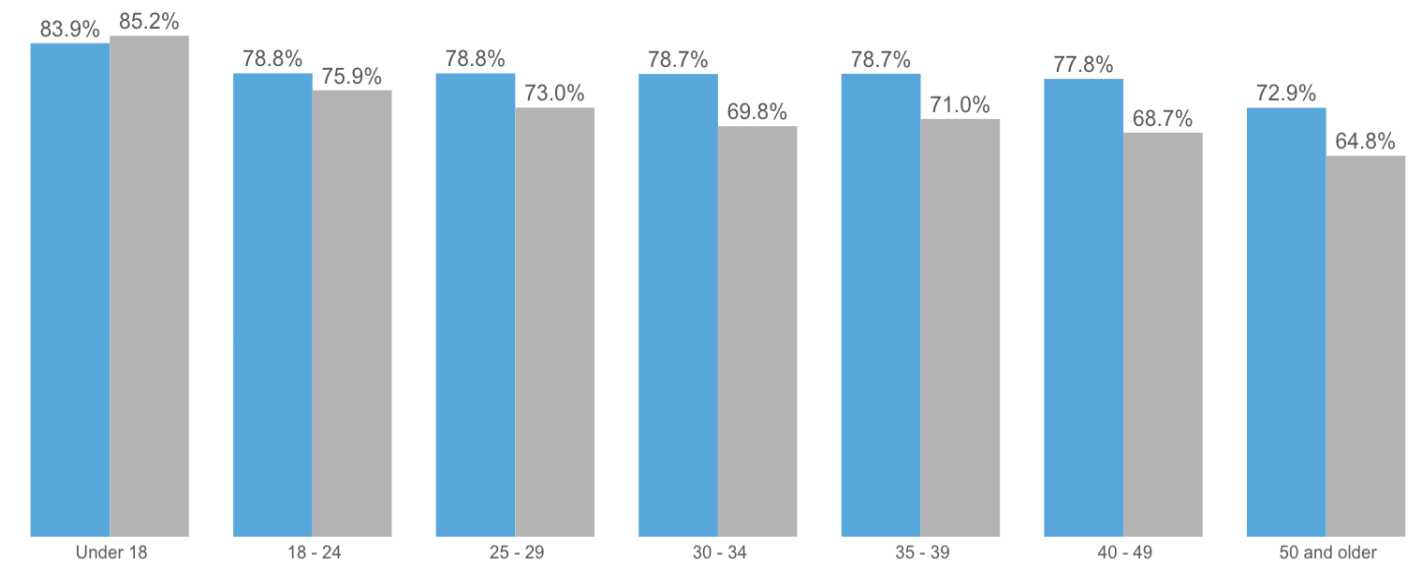
Course Completion

• WBL Students • Non-WBL Students



Course Success

• WBL Students • Non-WBL Students



WBL Dashboard Impact: Coding Improvements & District Growth

↑53%

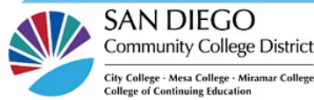
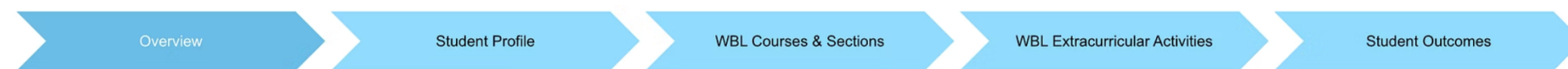
District WBL Headcount Growth

Improved Data & Coding

- Robust coding standards
- Better WBL activity tracking
- Accurate data & reporting

 Note: Some WBL experiences are still not fully tracked as colleges continue to refine their processes.

Demo: WBL Interactive Dashboard



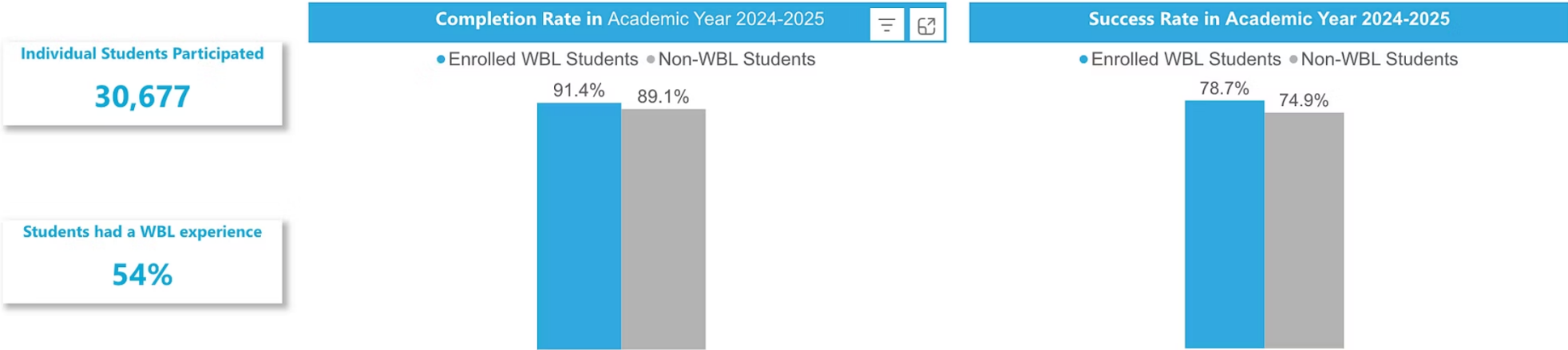
WORK-BASED LEARNING (WBL) - Credit Colleges ⓘ

Overview

Academic Year
2024-2025

College
All

WBL Category
All



Enrolled WBL Students Trends ⓘ

Hover over to view trends for the selected year by term.

Select View:

Chart View

Table View

Select a Metric:

☒ Enrolled WBL Students

☐ WBL Student Completion Rate

☐ WBL Student Success Rate

☐ WBL Courses

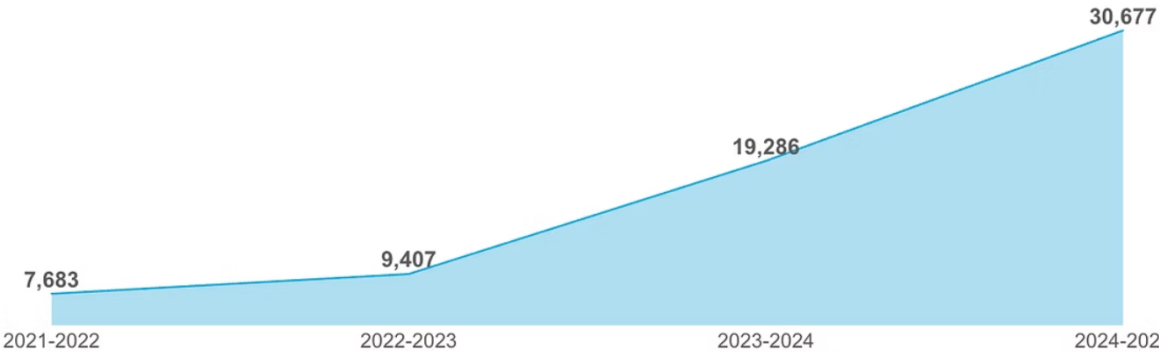
☐ WBL Sections

☐ WBL Student Headcount (WBL Courses & Sections Only)

☐ WBL Experiences (WBL Courses & Sections Only)

☐ WBL Student Headcount (WBL Extracurricular Activities Only)

☐ WBL Experiences (WBL Extracurricular Activities Only)



Note: Low extracurricular WBL counts likely reflect capacity limits and data coding challenges, not the actual opportunities provided to students.

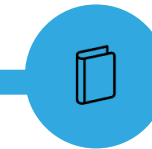
Add QR
Code to the
dashboard

Challenge: Barriers to Dashboard Use



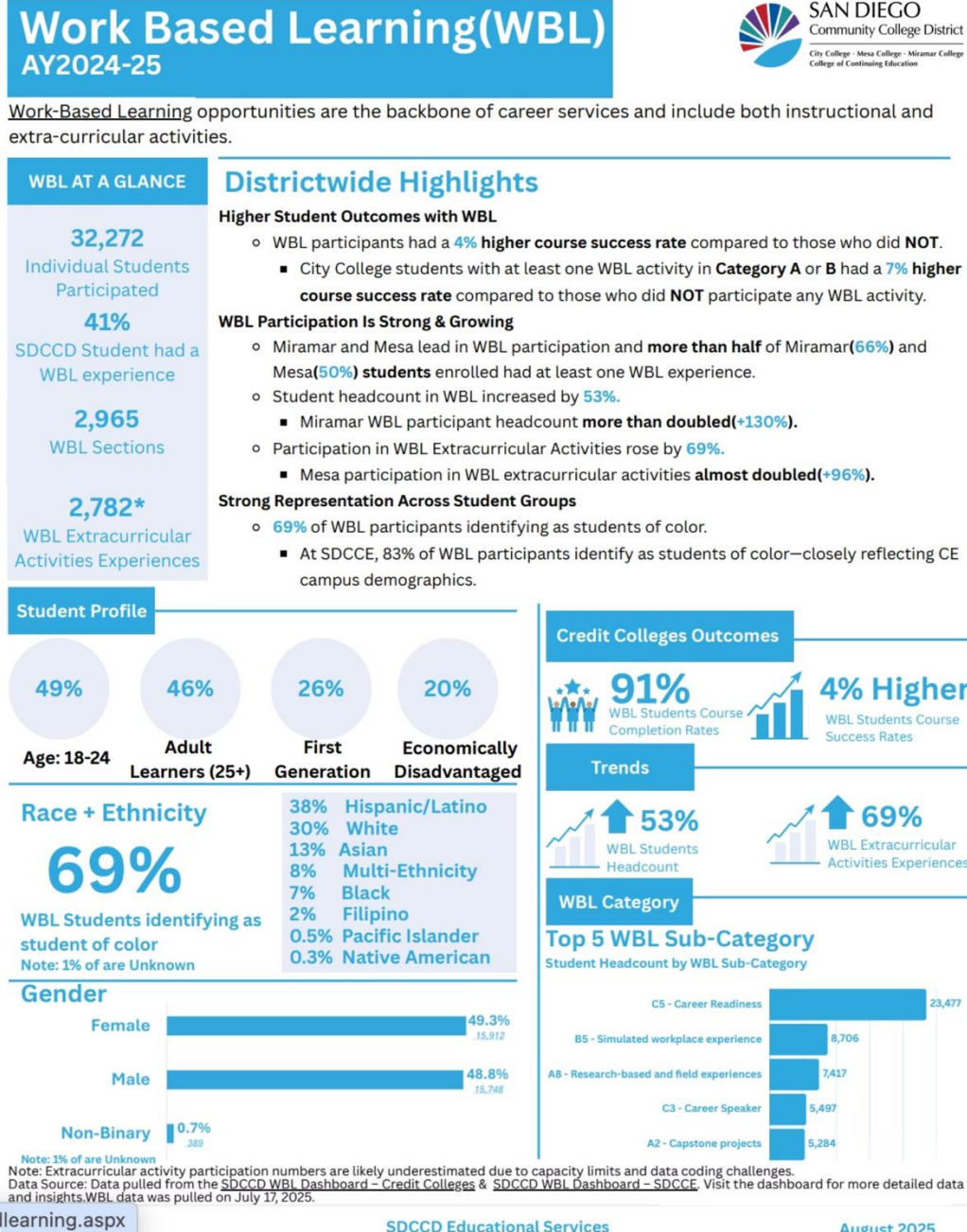
Limited Time

Faculty lack time for data exploration.



Varying Data Literacy

Different skill levels across users.



Solution: One-Page Summary

Dashboard Update

Fresh data loaded into Power BI

One Page Summary Design

College-specific one-pagers created

Wide Distribution

Easy reference for faculty and administrators

Custom GPT Demo

What It Does Well

- Answers FAQs in plain language
- Points users to dashboards and contacts
- Provides instant WBL guidance

Current Limitations

- Cannot read live dashboard data
- Not embedded on websites
- Requires curated PDF uploads

Access & Replication

Chat with the SDCCD WBL Assistant

[View Setup Guide](#)

Add clickable links to this page too



Website Integration Options

Option 1: Third-Party Solution

Example: Chatbase

Pros: Quick deployment, embeddable widgets

Cons: Ongoing subscription costs, vendor dependency

Option 2: Custom Development

Backend: Replit + OpenAI API integration

Frontend: Voiceflow or React widget

Cost: Pay-per-use API model (cents per query)

Key Considerations Before Launching



Is your Data Ready?

- Ensure source data is accurately coded before implementation.
- Address challenges related to data representation and trustworthiness.
- A foundational step may be optimizing the underlying data infrastructure.



Resource Trade-offs

- Evaluate the cost-benefit ratio of embedding the solution on the website.
- Calculate the total cost, including ongoing API expenses.
- Assess user adoption: Will faculty and staff actually utilize the chatbot?
- Confirm the solution delivers measurable value and support.

AI Landscape



Large Language Model

Specialized for natural language generation and understanding. Excellent for summarization, Q&A, and content drafting.

Example:

- ChatGPT
- Copilot

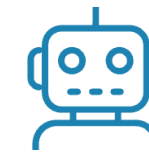


AI Workflow

A repeatable pipeline that pairs with your tools to watch for new rules, update mappings, validate the data, generate the required reports, and draft the notifications.

Example:

- N8n
- Zapier



AI Agent

An autonomous analyst that plans and executes multi-step work across your systems—pulls data, cleans it, computes metrics, fills the required forms, and drafts/schedules communications.

Example:

- N8n
- Zapier

Q&A

Add some sort of open q&A or recap slide?? Or maybe not needed?

Resources

Add link to dashboard

SG21 MIS Data Element

San Diego Community College District

- Dashboard
- Districtwide Reporting Framework
- Districtwide Work-Based Learning Resource Page

San Diego Imperial Counties Regional Consortium Resources

- Regional SG21 Resource Page
- WBL Infographic
- Regional WBL Glossary
- Regional Ensuring Equity WBL Framework
- Regional Subcategories Framework
- Regional Faculty WBL Professional Development

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